

How can could DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams potentially be used to improve AI prompting?

DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams let managers 'see' what an organization or initiative is trying to achieve, visually presenting outcomes and the steps needed to achieve them. These diagrams are then used to oversee and manage an organization as it acts in the world. DoView planning, in an organizational context, addresses the challenge of overseeing and controlling action in the world. These are exactly the same management and oversight challenges we now face regarding AI agents and AI-driven robotic systems.

For this reason, DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams should be explored as a way to clarify what an AI system plans to do in response to any plain-language prompt. Using DoView diagrams in conjunction with AI prompting could work as follows.

The user would start as usual by prompting the AI system in everyday language. They would then have a 'DoView' tab available in the prompt window. Clicking on this tab would get the AI to show what it thinks it is being instructed to do in the form of a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram. As is the case with organizational planning, this would give the user a clear visual check on whether the AI system truly understands what they want it to do.

The user can review and tweak the proposed DoView diagram, ensuring that what the AI system plans to do aligns with their intentions. There is potential to let the AI indicate the priority it assigns to steps, and for users to adjust these as needed. Careful attention to the human-AI interface would be needed to optimize usability. Just as with organizational DoView planning, this approach offers finer control over how an AI agent acts.

It would provide a low-cognitive-load way for humans to interact with and direct AI agents. Using DoViews to capture outcomes and planned steps could become a valuable tool for AI explainability, transparency, alignment, risk management, and control. AI agents could then be audited by other AI systems for compliance with their stated DoView diagrams.